

<i>She is so hyper and can never focus.</i>	During the 20-minute morning circle, Priya left her spot 6 times. She returned when a teacher stood beside her. During small group activities with manipulatives, she remained seated and engaged for 12 minutes continuously.
Why this is better: The objective version describes specific, observable actions including time, frequency, and exact words. It does not label the child or interpret the behavior. Anyone reading this record can understand exactly what occurred.	

Example 4: Sensory Processing

✗ Instead of writing:	✓ Write instead:
<i>He freaks out during lunch because of his sensory issues.</i>	On 8 of the past 10 school days during lunch, Carlos pushed away foods with soft or mushy textures after one or two bites. He said 'yucky' or 'no' and covered his mouth. He ate crackers, carrots, and apple slices without difficulty.
Why this is better: The objective version describes specific, observable actions including time, frequency, and exact words. It does not label the child or interpret the behavior. Anyone reading this record can understand exactly what occurred.	

Example 5: Communication

✗ Instead of writing:	✓ Write instead:
<i>She barely talks. She's really delayed.</i>	During a 30-minute observation of free play, Nadia communicated primarily using gestures (pointing, reaching) and 3–4 single words. She did not yet use two-word combinations during this observation. She responded to her name 3 out of 5 times.
Why this is better: The objective version describes specific, observable actions including time, frequency, and exact words. It does not label the child or interpret the behavior. Anyone reading this record can understand exactly what occurred.	

Example 6: Challenging Behavior During Transitions

✗ Instead of writing:	✓ Write instead:
<i>He's defiant every time we clean up. He's manipulative.</i>	During clean-up time on Monday, Tuesday, and Wednesday, Eli sat under the table and said 'I don't want to' when given the clean-up